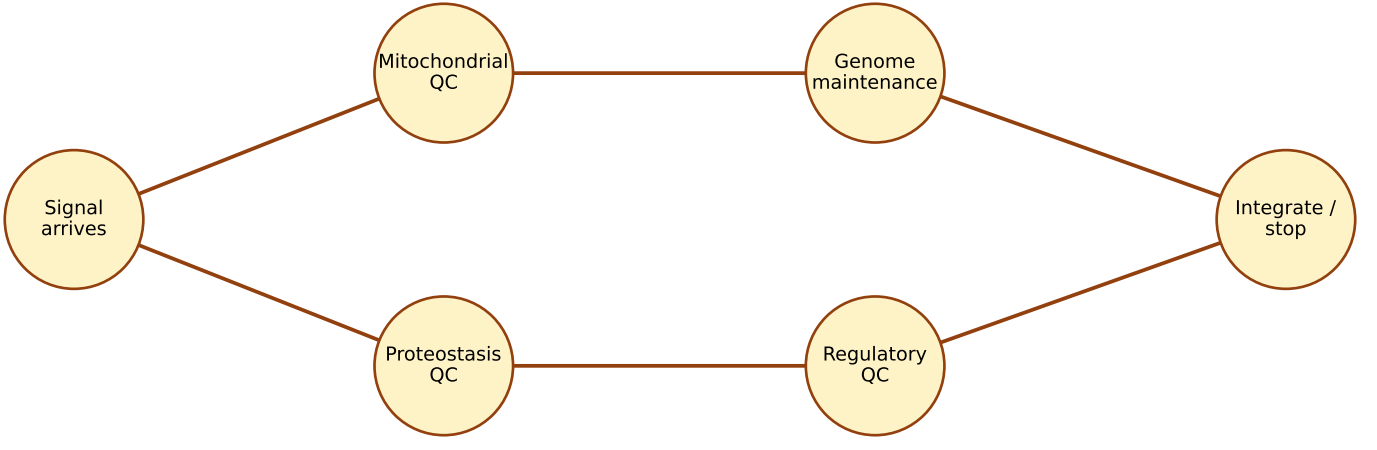Max-plus precedence example (conceptual, not inferred biology)